

InstaDesk

Multi-monitor launcher & window-tiling — User Manual

FcXe Studios · v0.1 · English

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1 • What is InstaDesk?

InstaDesk turns the tedious morning ritual — opening the same apps and dragging every window into place across several monitors — into a single click.

You arrange apps on a visual grid for each monitor, save that arrangement as a **Layout**, and from then on one **Apply** launches every app and tiles it exactly where you put it. You can keep many layouts (work, design, trading, streaming...), bundle several into a **Quick Preset**, or ad-hoc **Snap** a single window into place.

Is it hard? No — the learning curve is quick. But InstaDesk is a power tool with real depth (per-monitor grids, custom launch arguments, browser tab groups). This manual walks every feature; the in-app **Help** tab is the short version.

2 · Core concepts

Five ideas are all you need:

Monitor

You arrange one display at a time. The **Monitor** selector (left panel) chooses which; the **Display Array** shows how your screens are physically laid out.

Grid & cells

Each monitor is divided into a grid of **cells** (e.g. 6×6). You can set a different grid density per monitor.

Region

A rectangular block of cells you assign one app to. A region can be a single cell or a wide band — for example the left half of a monitor.

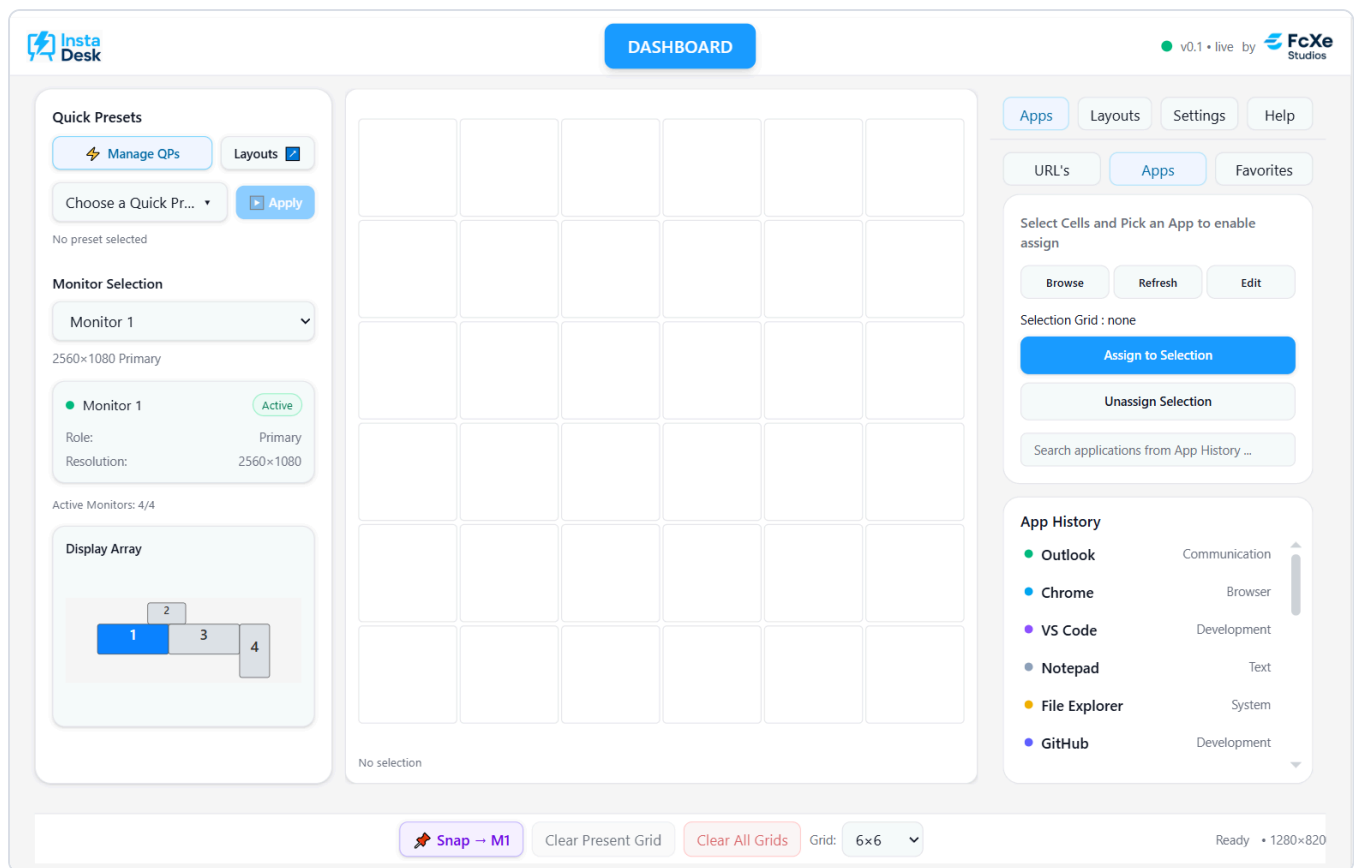
Layout

A saved set of regions across all your monitors — the heart of InstaDesk. Apply it to launch and tile everything.

Quick Preset

A bundle of several Layouts you apply together in one click.

3 · The interface, at a glance



- **Left panel** — Quick Presets, the Monitor selector, and the Display Array.
- **Centre** — the workspace grid for the selected monitor, where you select cells and see assignments.
- **Right panel** — tabs for **Apps**, **Layouts**, **Settings**, and **Help**.
- **Bottom bar** — **Snap**, **Clear Present Grid**, **Clear All Grids**, and the per-monitor **Grid** size.

4 · Quick start: your first layout

1. Pick a monitor in the left panel.
2. In the centre grid, **drag across cells** to select a region (say, the left half).
3. Open the **Apps** tab, choose an app (e.g. Chrome), and click **Assign to Selection**.
4. Select another region and assign a second app. Repeat for other monitors via the Monitor selector.
5. Open the **Layouts** tab → + **New Layout**, pick a slot letter, and save.
6. Click **Apply** on the layout card — InstaDesk launches each app and tiles it into place.

The screenshot shows the InstaDesk dashboard interface. At the top, there's a "DASHBOARD" button and a version indicator "v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios". The left sidebar contains several sections: "Quick Presets" with a "Manage QPs" button and a "Layouts" toggle; "Monitor Selection" with a dropdown set to "Monitor 1" and details for "2560x1080 Primary"; and "Display Array" showing a 4-monitor layout. The main area is a 6x6 grid where the first 6 columns and first 3 rows (18 cells) are selected and labeled "Chrome". The bottom status bar shows "Selected: 0-6 x 0-3 = 18 cells". The right sidebar has tabs for "Apps", "Layouts", "Settings", and "Help". Under the "Apps" tab, there are "URL's", "Apps", and "Favorites" sections. The "Apps" section shows "Selection Grid : 18" and an "Assign to Selection" button. Below that is the "App History" section listing "Outlook" (Communication), "Chrome" (Browser), and "VS Code" (Development).

5 · The grid & assigning apps

Selecting & assigning

Drag across cells to select a rectangular region, then click **Assign to Selection** in the Apps tab. Use **Unassign Selection** to clear it. Regions must be rectangles.

Grid size (per monitor)

The **Grid** selector in the bottom bar sets the density of the *current* monitor — 6×6 for broad zones, 10×10 for fine control. Each monitor remembers its own size. Changing it on a monitor that already has apps asks for confirmation, since it re-shapes that grid.

Custom launch arguments

Give a cell its own launch arguments in the Apps tab — for example a folder path for File Explorer, so two regions open two *different* folders of the same app. This is how you place several distinct windows of one program.

The screenshot shows the InstaDesk Dashboard interface. At the top, there's a 'DASHBOARD' button and a version indicator 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main area is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes 'Manage QPs', 'Layouts', and a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown with an 'Apply' button. Below this, it says 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu showing 'Monitor 1' with a resolution of '2560×1080 Primary'. Below this, it shows 'Active Monitors: 4/4' and a 'Display Array' diagram with four numbered monitors.
- Grid:** A 6x6 grid of 36 cells, each containing the text 'File Explorer'. Below the grid, it says 'Selected: 0-6 × 0-6 • 36 cells'.
- Apps Tab:** On the right, there's a tab labeled 'Apps' with sub-tabs 'URL's', 'Apps', and 'Favorites'. Below these, there's a 'Select Cells and Pick an App to enable assign' section with 'Browse', 'Refresh', and 'Edit' buttons. Below that, it says 'Selection Grid : 36' and has 'Assign to Selection' and 'Unassign Selection' buttons. Further down, there's a 'LAUNCH ARGS FOR SELECTION' section with a 'Reset' button and an 'Apply' button. Below this, it says 'App default is empty. Whatever you type here is appended to the launch command.' and a 'Search applications from App History ...' input field.
- App History:** A list of applications: 'File Explorer' (System), 'GitHub' (Development), and 'Stack Overflow' (Development).

At the bottom, there's a bar with buttons: 'Snap → M1', 'Clear Present Grid', 'Clear All Grids', and a 'Grid: 6×6' dropdown. On the right, it says '36 cells selected, 36 assigned • 1280×820'.

Clearing

Clear Present Grid empties the current monitor; **Clear All Grids** empties every monitor (with a confirmation). Saved Layouts are never affected by clearing.

6 · Apps, URLs & Favorites

The right-panel **Apps** tab has three sub-tabs.

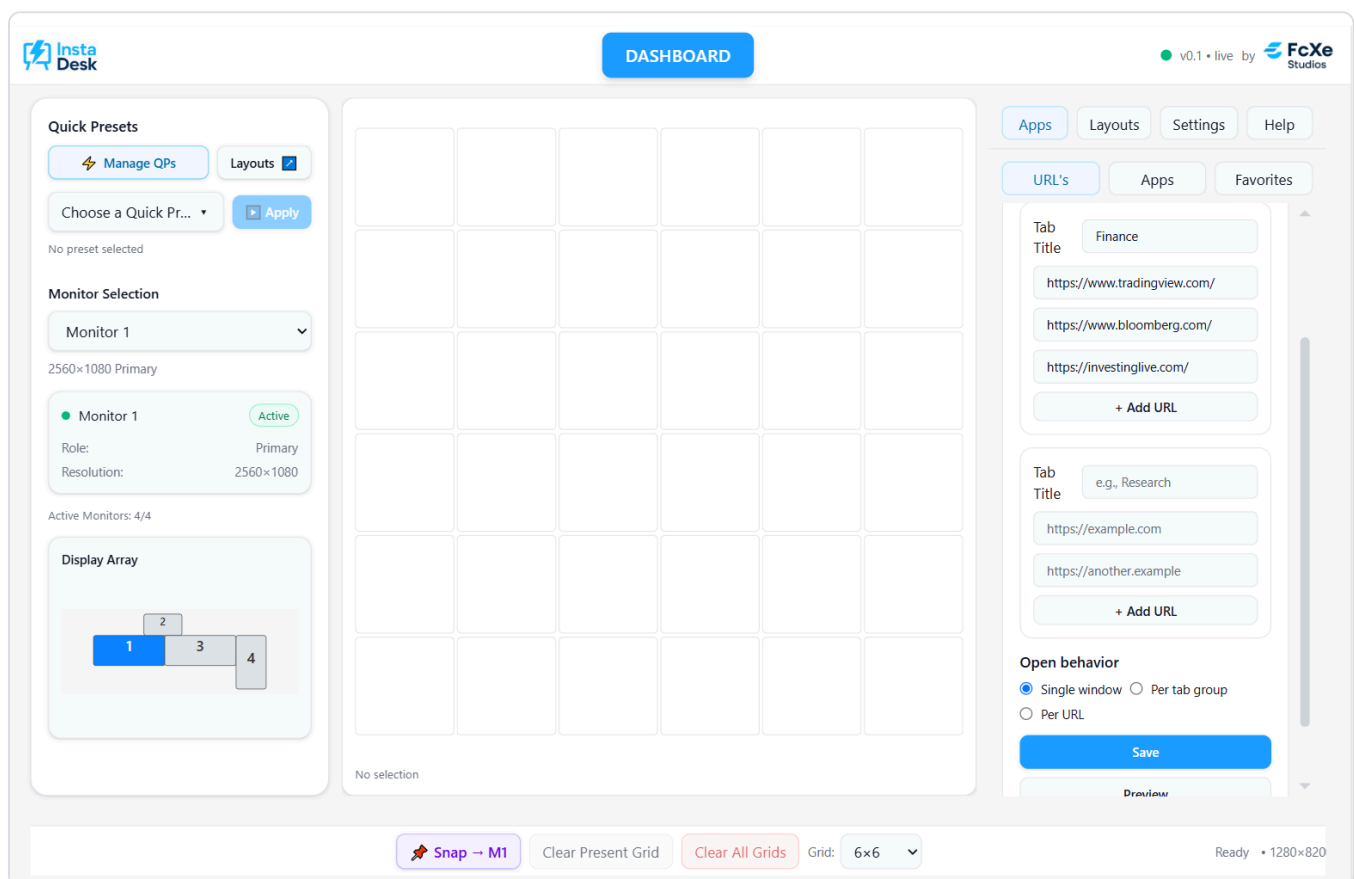
Apps

Pick from the built-in catalog, or click **Browse...** to add any program's `.exe`. Added programs are remembered in **App History** for reuse.

URLs — the URL Builder

Build a group of browser tabs that open together in their own window:

1. Choose a **Browser**. Click **+ Add Browser** to pick from the browsers detected on your PC, or browse for a browser's `.exe`.
2. Add a **Tab Group**, give it a title, and add the URLs.
3. Set the **open behavior** (one window, per group, or per URL) and **Save**. The group then behaves like any app you can assign to the grid.



Favorites

Keep your most-used apps and URLs one click away.

7 · Layouts

A Layout stores which apps go where, across *all* your monitors. When you save with **+ New Layout**, give it a name you'll recognise — for example “Work”, “Trading”, or “Editing”. You can keep up to **26** saved Layouts at a time.

- **Apply** — launches and tiles everything in the layout.
- **Edit** — reopens the layout on the grid so you can rearrange and re-save.
- **Rename** (✎) — give a layout a new name; its contents stay the same.
- **Export / Import** — share a layout as a `.json` file (its name travels with it).

If a saved app has no program or URL configured, only that one app is skipped on save (with a warning) — the rest of the layout still saves normally.

The screenshot displays the InstaDesk Dashboard interface for managing multi-monitor layouts. The top navigation bar includes the InstaDesk logo, a 'DASHBOARD' button, and version information (v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios). The main interface is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes a 'Manage QPs' button, a 'Layouts' tab, and an 'Apply' button. A message states 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** A dropdown menu shows 'Monitor 1' selected. Below it, details for 'Monitor 1' are listed: '2560x1080 Primary', 'Role: Primary', and 'Resolution: 2560x1080'. A status indicator shows 'Active'.
- Display Array:** A diagram shows four monitors arranged in a 2x2 grid, numbered 1 to 4.
- Layout A (general slot A):** The central workspace shows a grid of four monitors (M1, M2, M3, M4) with various applications tiled on them:
 - M1: Two instances of 'File Explorer'.
 - M2: 'iVMS-4200 3.6.1.3 Client'.
 - M3: 'VS Studio Code'.
 - M4: 'Crypto Utilities', 'Entertainment', and 'Varios' (all with '--new-window' labels).
- Layouts Panel (Right):** Contains buttons for '+ New Layout' and 'Import...'. Below, it lists saved layouts:
 - Layout A:** 'general slot A', 'Hide content', path 'C:\FcXe Studios\Instadesk\data\prese...', updated '2026-06-08 09:40'. Buttons: 'Apply', 'Edit', 'Export', 'Delete'.
 - Layout B:** 'general slot B', 'Show content', path 'C:\FcXe Studios\Instadesk\data\prese...', updated '2026-06-08 10:52'. Buttons: 'Apply', 'Edit', 'Export', 'Delete'.

At the bottom, there are buttons for 'Snap → M1', 'Clear Present Grid', and 'Clear All Grids', along with a 'Grid: 6x6' selector. The status bar at the bottom right shows 'Ready • 1280x820'.

8 • Quick Presets

A Quick Preset bundles several Layouts so you can apply them all together with one click — ideal for a full multi-monitor workspace assembled from reusable pieces. You can keep up to **26** Quick Presets.

1. Click **Manage QPs** in the left panel.
2. Create a preset and add the Layouts it should include.
3. Back on the main screen, pick the Quick Preset and click **Apply**.

9 • Snap

Snap places a *single, already-open* window into a region — no Layout required.

1. Click **Snap** → **M1** in the bottom bar (the number is the active monitor).
2. A grid popup appears on that monitor.
3. Click a region; the window you last used snaps into it.

Some apps enforce their own position (certain CCTV / video tools) and may refuse to be moved.

10 • Monitors & Settings

Use the **Monitor** selector to switch which display you're arranging; the **Display Array** shows their physical layout. The **Settings** tab offers:

- **Theme** — Light, Dark, or System.
- **Language** — English or Español.
- **Default grid size** — the size new/cleared monitors start at.
- **Window margin** — a bezel-aware gap so tiled windows don't sit under your monitor frames.

The screenshot displays the Insta Desk Dashboard interface. At the top, there's a 'DASHBOARD' button and a status bar indicating 'v0.1 • live by FcXe Studios'. The main area is divided into several sections:

- Quick Presets:** Includes a 'Manage QPs' button, a 'Layouts' dropdown, and a 'Choose a Quick Pr...' dropdown with an 'Apply' button. Below this, it states 'No preset selected'.
- Monitor Selection:** Features a 'Monitor 1' dropdown menu. Below it, it shows '2560×1080 Primary'. A list of monitors shows 'Monitor 1' as 'Active' with a role of 'Primary' and a resolution of '2560×1080'. It also indicates 'Active Monitors: 4/4'.
- Display Array:** Shows a visual representation of the monitor layout with four numbered monitors (1, 2, 3, 4) arranged in a 2x2 grid. Below this, it says 'No selection'.
- Settings:** A sidebar on the right with tabs for 'Apps', 'Layouts', 'Settings' (selected), and 'Help'. It contains two main sections:
 - General:** Includes a 'Launch on system start' toggle (checked), a 'Theme' dropdown set to 'System', and a 'Language' dropdown set to 'English'.
 - Grid & Snapping:** Includes a 'Default grid size' dropdown set to '6 × 6' and a 'Window margin' dropdown set to 'Off (0 px)'.

At the bottom, there's a status bar with a 'Snap → M1' button, 'Clear Present Grid' and 'Clear All Grids' buttons, a 'Grid: 6×6' dropdown, and a 'Ready • 1280×820' status indicator.

11 · Tips & troubleshooting

- **An app won't tile.** Some apps (certain CCTV / video tools) place their own windows. Close and relaunch them, or leave them out of the layout.
- **Only one window opens.** Single-instance apps (e.g. Outlook, Teams) open just one window; assigning them to several cells won't create copies.
- **A shortcut won't launch.** Windows shortcuts (`.lnk`) can't be launched directly — point to the real `.exe` in the Apps tab instead.
- **An app fails to launch.** Check its path in the Apps tab and use **Browse...** to correct it.
- **My added browser disappeared / opened the wrong browser.** Use + **Add Browser** and pick a detected browser (or browse to its `.exe`) so InstaDesk has its real program path.

12 · Limits & capacities

At a glance, what InstaDesk can hold:

Item	Limit
Saved Layouts — multi-monitor	26
Saved Layouts — single-monitor	26
Quick Presets	26
Grid density (per monitor)	4×4, 6×6, 8×8 or 10×10
Windows placed per monitor (one Layout)	up to the grid size — 36 at 6×6, 100 at 10×10
Monitors	every monitor Windows detects
Window margin (bezel padding)	0–16 px
URLs per group · Favorites	no fixed limit

Reached 26 saved Layouts? Delete one to free a slot, or combine related Layouts into a Quick Preset. Higher limits are planned for a future update if customers need them.